FEASIBILITY

Feasibility: five ways to use the building

In the average case the five plans need $7.1M to $19.3M, including buying the property at an assumed $3.0M plus fees and closing. Once open they make $375k to $1.0M profit a year, so they earn it back in 16.3 to 25.6 years. No plan earns it back faster than a typical investment property (about 12 years). In the best case they earn it back in 9.8 to 15.3 years.

Buying the property is included

Purchase included. Every number on this page includes buying the property at an assumed price of $3.0M, plus fees, closing costs, surveys and inspections. Building costs are at Memphis prices, with the ownership group managing the work and hiring each trade directly instead of paying one general contractor to do everything.

Hall bookings matter most in the three plans where the owners run the halls: the average case assumes 215 events a year across both halls.

The plan cards follow the case you pick below; the range chart shows all three at once.

To test other costs, income or events yourself, use Try your own numbers. Nothing you type is saved.

Printed view: the plan cards, the businesses and the column costs show the average case (the typical outcome: half of the simulated futures do better and half do worse); the range chart and its table show all three cases. Every number includes buying the property at an assumed $3.0M plus fees and closing.

01 · FIVE PLANS

What each plan costs and what it makes

Each card shows the **average** case. “Profit each year” is before any loan payments. Every number includes buying the property at an assumed $3.0M plus fees and closing.

How the three cases work

Likely outcomes, not extremes

Every input, from building costs and rents to hall bookings, prices and running costs, has a researched range: a bad end, a most likely value and a good end. 10,000 simulated futures let each input land anywhere in its range, more often near the most likely value, with related inputs moving together (bookings with prices, building costs with each other). Each case puts every input at the same point in its range, chosen so the efficient full plan matches the 1-in-10, typical and 1-in-10 results. Hall B is built in every case.

Stress test, not a forecast: if every input sat at its bad end at the same time, the hall plans would lose money every year and never earn back; no more than 0.7% of the simulated futures did that badly. If every input sat at its good end at once, the plans would earn back in about 4–8 years; none of the simulated futures did that well.

Average case: the money put in comes back in 16.3 years (Efficient full plan) to 25.6 years (Lease everything). No plan earns it back faster than a typical investment property (about 12 years).

Lease everything

Opens in about 18 months

× Slower than a typical investment property (about 12 years)

Money in (buying + building, one-time) Includes buying at an assumed $3.0M plus fees and closing	$15.9M
Money coming in each year	$1.2M
Money going out each year	$547k
Profit each year Before any loan payments	$623k
Years to earn back the money put in	25.6 years
Profit each year for every $100 spent	$3.91

Biggest one-time costs: Fit-out help for tenants ($1.6M); Cushion for surprises ($1.0M); Heating and air conditioning (rooftop units) ($952k).

Chance it never earns back: fewer than 1 in 1,000.

Biggest yearly costs: Upkeep: parking lot, lighting, landscaping, common areas ($185k); Property tax ($159k).

What gets built. The full program as drawn, but every space is leased: an outside operator rents Hall A and Hall B, a playground operator rents the kids' center, shops and flex space are leased, and a fuel company rents the frontage land for a gas station.

Who runs what. Tenants only

Money in and out each year

Where it comes from and where it goes

Where the money comes from each year

Item	Per year
Shop rents	$350k
Flex space rents (open, warehouse-style units)	$141k
Kids' center rent	$87k
Hall operator rent	$95k
Land rent from the gas station	$85k
Land rent from a restaurant pad on Summer Ave	$19k
Tenants repay their share of tax, insurance and upkeep	$392k
Money coming in each year	**$1.2M**

Where it goes each year

Item	Per year
Allowance for empty-space gaps and unpaid rent	$26k
Property tax	$159k
Insurance, including flood	$91k
Upkeep: parking lot, lighting, landscaping, common areas	$185k
Property management	$56k
Set-aside for roof and AC repairs	$30k
Money going out each year	**$547k**

Profit each year: $623k.

What the money pays for

Buying and building, line by line, average case

Item	One-time
Buying the property (assumed $3.0M) and closing	
Purchase price (assumed)	$3.0M
Fees, closing costs, surveys and inspections	$276k
Subtotal	**$3.3M**
Building work (roof, heating and AC, fire safety, restrooms, parking, flood, columns)	
Roof repairs, coating or replacement	$771k
Heating and air conditioning (rooftop units)	$952k
Fire sprinklers	$304k
Fire alarm with voice evacuation	$468k
Clearing out the old store interior	$367k
New shop fronts	$572k
New entrances and canopies	$510k
Walls between tenant spaces	$552k
Restrooms	$795k
Electrical	$487k
Plumbing	$209k
Parking lot repair and repaving	$631k
Site work, lighting and landscaping	$328k
Outside walls and paint	$328k
Stormwater detention	$91k
Flood compliance work	$328k
Removing the 4 hall columns (steel beams)	$748k
Subtotal	**$8.4M**
Finishing the halls and kitchens	
Nothing under this heading in this plan	*$0*
Subtotal	**$0**
Design, permits and a cushion for surprises	
Design, engineering, permits and surveys	$617k
Cushion for surprises	$1.0M
Subtotal	**$1.7M**
Signing tenants: build-out allowances and broker fees	
Fit-out help for tenants	$1.6M
Leasing commissions	$276k
Subtotal	**$1.9M**
Holding the building and loan interest during the work	
Tax, insurance and upkeep while building	$264k
Construction-loan interest	$362k
Subtotal	**$626k**
Money in (buying + building, one-time)	**$15.9M**

Includes $748k to take out four roof columns in the halls.

Full plan (as drawn)

Opens in about 18 months

× Slower than a typical investment property (about 12 years)

Money in (buying + building, one-time) Includes buying at an assumed $3.0M plus fees and closing	$19.3M
Money coming in each year	$3.3M
Money going out each year	$2.3M
Profit each year Before any loan payments	$1.0M
Years to earn back the money put in	19.1 years
Profit each year for every $100 spent	$5.24

Biggest one-time costs: Hall finishes, lighting and sound ($2.8M); Kitchens: hoods, fire suppression, grease trap, walk-ins ($1.1M); Cushion for surprises ($1.1M).

Chance it never earns back: fewer than 1 in 1,000.

Biggest yearly costs: Halls: year-round staff, utilities, insurance, equipment lease ($572k); Halls: card fees, marketing, supplies, repairs ($319k).

What gets built. Everything at once: Hall A and Hall B with twin kitchens and dining, the 18,000 SF kids' playground, about 22 small shops, flex space split into rentable units and the fuel pad. Each main room has a movable wall, so it can hold one large event or two 150–350 guest events at once.

Who runs what. Owners' operating company runs the halls. Tenants: shops, flex, kids' center, fuel.

Money in and out each year

Where it comes from and where it goes

Where the money comes from each year

Item	Per year
Shop rents	$350k
Flex space rents (open, warehouse-style units)	$141k
Kids' center rent	$87k
Land rent from the gas station	$85k
Land rent from a restaurant pad on Summer Ave	$19k
Tenants repay their share of tax, insurance and upkeep	$195k
Hall bookings: room rental	$1.2M
Hall bookings: catering	$985k
Hall bookings: service charge on catering	$197k
Hall bookings: kitchen fees from outside caterers	$79k
Money coming in each year	**$3.3M**

Where it goes each year

Item	Per year
Allowance for empty-space gaps and unpaid rent	$23k
Property tax	$104k
Insurance, including flood	$91k
Upkeep: parking lot, lighting, landscaping, common areas	$185k
Property management	$42k
Set-aside for roof and AC repairs	$30k
Halls: food for catered events	$311k
Halls: catering staff	$285k
Halls: service charge paid to event staff	$98k
Halls: event-day staff (setup, cleaning, security)	$258k
Halls: card fees, marketing, supplies, repairs	$319k
Halls: year-round staff, utilities, insurance, equipment lease	$572k
Money going out each year	**$2.3M**

Profit each year: $1.0M.

What the money pays for

Buying and building, line by line, average case

Item	One-time
Buying the property (assumed $3.0M) and closing	
Purchase price (assumed)	$3.0M
Fees, closing costs, surveys and inspections	$276k
Subtotal	**$3.3M**
Building work (roof, heating and AC, fire safety, restrooms, parking, flood, columns)	
Roof repairs, coating or replacement	$771k
Heating and air conditioning (rooftop units)	$952k
Fire sprinklers	$304k
Fire alarm with voice evacuation	$468k
Clearing out the old store interior	$367k
New shop fronts	$572k
New entrances and canopies	$510k
Walls between tenant spaces	$552k
Restrooms	$795k
Electrical	$487k
Plumbing	$209k
Parking lot repair and repaving	$631k
Site work, lighting and landscaping	$328k
Outside walls and paint	$328k
Stormwater detention	$91k
Flood compliance work	$328k
Removing the 4 hall columns (steel beams)	$748k
Movable walls that split each main room	$242k
Subtotal	**$8.7M**
Finishing the halls and kitchens	
Hall finishes, lighting and sound	$2.8M
Kitchens: hoods, fire suppression, grease trap, walk-ins	$1.1M
Opening costs and starting cash for the halls	$123k
Subtotal	**$4.0M**
Design, permits and a cushion for surprises	
Design, engineering, permits and surveys	$635k
Cushion for surprises	$1.1M
Subtotal	**$1.7M**
Signing tenants: build-out allowances and broker fees	
Fit-out help for tenants	$921k
Leasing commissions	$233k
Subtotal	**$1.2M**
Holding the building and loan interest during the work	

Tax, insurance and upkeep while building	**$264k**
Construction-loan interest	**$238k**
Subtotal	**$502k**
Money in (buying + building, one-time)	**$19.3M**

[1] Includes $748k to take out four roof columns in the halls.

Full plan, built efficiently

Opens in about 15 months

× Slower than a typical investment property (about 12 years)

Money in (buying + building, one-time) $16.0M

Includes buying at an assumed $3.0M plus fees and closing

> Biggest one-time costs: Hall finishes, lighting and sound ($2.5M); Kitchens: hoods, fire suppression, grease trap, walk-ins ($950k); Removing the 4 hall columns (steel beams) ($748k).

Money coming in each year	$3.3M
Money going out each year	$2.3M
Profit each year Before any loan payments	$981k
Years to earn back the money put in	16.3 years
Profit each year for every $100 spent	$6.12

Chance it never earns back: fewer than 1 in 1,000.

> Biggest yearly costs: Halls: year-round staff, utilities, insurance, equipment lease ($632k); Halls: food for catered events ($311k).

What gets built. Same final uses, built leaner: 12 larger shop bays instead of 22, flex left open until leased, roof repaired and coated where sound, HVAC replaced only for the halls and kids' center, existing restroom cores reused, hall furniture and kitchen equipment leased. The movable walls in the main rooms stay.

Who runs what. Same as the full plan.

Money in and out each year

Where it comes from and where it goes

Where the money comes from each year

Item	Per year
Shop rents	$326k
Flex space rents (open, warehouse-style units)	$121k
Kids' center rent	$87k
Land rent from the gas station	$85k
Land rent from a restaurant pad on Summer Ave	$19k
Tenants repay their share of tax, insurance and upkeep	$198k
Hall bookings: room rental	$1.2M
Hall bookings: catering	$985k
Hall bookings: service charge on catering	$197k
Hall bookings: kitchen fees from outside caterers	$79k
Money coming in each year	**$3.3M**

Where it goes each year

Item	Per year
Allowance for empty-space gaps and unpaid rent	$21k
Property tax	$114k
Insurance, including flood	$91k
Upkeep: parking lot, lighting, landscaping, common areas	$185k
Property management	$40k
Set-aside for roof and AC repairs	$30k
Halls: food for catered events	$311k
Halls: catering staff	$285k
Halls: service charge paid to event staff	$98k
Halls: event-day staff (setup, cleaning, security)	$258k
Halls: card fees, marketing, supplies, repairs	$245k
Halls: year-round staff, utilities, insurance, equipment lease	$632k
Money going out each year	**$2.3M**

Profit each year: $981k.

What the money pays for

Buying and building, line by line, average case

Item	One-time
Buying the property (assumed $3.0M) and closing	
Purchase price (assumed)	$3.0M
Fees, closing costs, surveys and inspections	$276k
Subtotal	**$3.3M**
Building work (roof, heating and AC, fire safety, restrooms, parking, flood, columns)	
Roof repairs, coating or replacement	$549k
Heating and air conditioning (rooftop units)	$642k
Fire sprinklers	$264k
Fire alarm with voice evacuation	$468k
Clearing out the old store interior	$298k
New shop fronts	$312k
New entrances and canopies	$363k
Walls between tenant spaces	$212k
Restrooms	$601k
Electrical	$430k
Plumbing	$183k
Parking lot repair and repaving	$588k
Site work, lighting and landscaping	$249k
Outside walls and paint	$245k
Stormwater detention	$91k
Flood compliance work	$328k
Removing the 4 hall columns (steel beams)	$748k
Movable walls that split each main room	$242k
Subtotal	**$6.8M**
Finishing the halls and kitchens	
Hall finishes, lighting and sound	$2.5M
Kitchens: hoods, fire suppression, grease trap, walk-ins	$950k
Opening costs and starting cash for the halls	$110k
Subtotal	**$3.5M**
Design, permits and a cushion for surprises	
Design, engineering, permits and surveys	$498k
Cushion for surprises	$702k
Subtotal	**$1.2M**
Signing tenants: build-out allowances and broker fees	
Fit-out help for tenants	$531k
Leasing commissions	$220k
Subtotal	**$751k**
Holding the building and loan interest during the work	

Tax, insurance and upkeep while building	**$220k**
Construction-loan interest	**$216k**
Subtotal	**$436k**
Money in (buying + building, one-time)	**$16.0M**

[1] Includes $748k to take out four roof columns in the halls.

Hybrid (phased)

Opens in about 10 months (first step)

× Slower than a typical investment property (about 12 years)

Money in (buying + building, one-time) Includes buying at an assumed $3.0M plus fees and closing	$14.7M
Money coming in each year	$3.1M
Money going out each year	$2.2M
Profit each year Before any loan payments	$819k
Years to earn back the money put in	18.0 years
Profit each year for every $100 spent	$5.56

Biggest one-time costs: Hall B and Kitchen B in year 3 (2 more columns, its movable wall, finishes and kitchen) ($2.7M); Hall finishes, lighting and sound ($1.5M); Parking lot repair and repaving ($588k).

Chance it never earns back: about 1 in 147.

First step, Hall A only: $12.0M to build and $448k profit a year, earning it back in 26.9 years. Adding Hall B later costs $2.7M more and gives the totals above.

Biggest yearly costs: Halls: year-round staff, utilities, insurance, equipment lease ($632k); Halls: food for catered events ($311k).

What gets built. Phase 1: Hall A, Kitchen A, the dining room and the kids' center; the rest is rented in its current condition on short leases. Phase 2 (year 3): Hall B and Kitchen B once Hall A books about 100 events a year. Each main room gets a movable wall when it is built.

Who runs what. Owners' operating company runs the halls. Tenants: kids' center, the rest of the space, fuel.

Money in and out each year

Where it comes from and where it goes

Where the money comes from each year

Item	Per year
Rents from space leased as it is	$248k
Kids' center rent	$87k
Land rent from the gas station	$85k
Land rent from a restaurant pad on Summer Ave	$19k
Tenants repay their share of tax, insurance and upkeep	$173k
Hall bookings: room rental	$1.2M
Hall bookings: catering	$985k
Hall bookings: service charge on catering	$197k
Hall bookings: kitchen fees from outside caterers	$79k
Money coming in each year	**$3.1M**

Where it goes each year

Item	Per year
Allowance for empty-space gaps and unpaid rent	$15k
Property tax	$69k
Insurance, including flood	$91k
Upkeep: parking lot, lighting, landscaping, common areas	$185k
Property management	$29k
Set-aside for roof and AC repairs	$30k
Halls: food for catered events	$311k
Halls: catering staff	$285k
Halls: service charge paid to event staff	$98k
Halls: event-day staff (setup, cleaning, security)	$258k
Halls: card fees, marketing, supplies, repairs	$245k
Halls: year-round staff, utilities, insurance, equipment lease	$632k
Money going out each year	**$2.2M**

Profit each year: $819k.

What the money pays for

Buying and building, line by line, average case

Item	One-time
Buying the property (assumed $3.0M) and closing	
Purchase price (assumed)	$3.0M
Fees, closing costs, surveys and inspections	$276k
Subtotal	**$3.3M**
Building work (roof, heating and AC, fire safety, restrooms, parking, flood, columns)	
Roof repairs, coating or replacement	$549k
Heating and air conditioning (rooftop units)	$441k
Fire sprinklers	$224k
Fire alarm with voice evacuation	$425k
Clearing out the old store interior	$186k
New entrances and canopies	$245k
Walls between tenant spaces	$193k
Restrooms	$389k
Electrical	$328k
Plumbing	$134k
Parking lot repair and repaving	$588k
Site work, lighting and landscaping	$227k
Outside walls and paint	$198k
Stormwater detention	$91k
Flood compliance work	$328k
Removing the 2 Hall A columns (steel beams)	$374k
Movable wall that splits Hall A	$121k
Subtotal	**$5.0M**
Finishing the halls and kitchens	
Hall finishes, lighting and sound	$1.5M
Kitchens: hoods, fire suppression, grease trap, walk-ins	$475k
Opening costs and starting cash for the halls	$80k
Subtotal	**$2.1M**
Design, permits and a cushion for surprises	
Design, engineering, permits and surveys	$369k
Cushion for surprises	$519k
Subtotal	**$888k**
Signing tenants: build-out allowances and broker fees	
Fit-out help for tenants	$337k
Leasing commissions	$184k
Subtotal	**$521k**
Holding the building and loan interest during the work	
Tax, insurance and upkeep while building	$147k

Construction-loan interest	**$96k**
Subtotal	**$243k**
Adding Hall B and Kitchen B later	
Hall B and Kitchen B in year 3 (2 more columns, its movable wall, finishes and kitchen)	**$2.7M**
Subtotal	**$2.7M**
Money in (buying + building, one-time)	**$14.7M**

Includes $374k to take out two roof columns in the halls (Hall A's); Hall B's two are in the cost of adding Hall B.

Lean hold

Opens in about 6 months

× Slower than a typical investment property (about 12 years)

Money in (buying + building, one-time) Includes buying at an assumed $3.0M plus fees and closing	$7.1M
Money coming in each year	$837k
Money going out each year	$461k
Profit each year Before any loan payments	$375k
Years to earn back the money put in	19.0 years
Profit each year for every $100 spent	$5.26

Biggest one-time costs: Roof repairs, coating or replacement ($481k); Fit-out help for tenants ($449k); Flood compliance work ($328k).

Chance it never earns back: fewer than 1 in 1,000.

Biggest yearly costs: Upkeep: parking lot, lighting, landscaping, common areas ($185k); Property tax ($96k).

What gets built. No halls yet. Repair the roof, HVAC, fire systems and parking, split the building into large blocks and rent them in their current condition to service, showroom, church, school, medical or back-office users. The halls stay an option for later.

Who runs what. Tenants only.

Money in and out each year

Where it comes from and where it goes

Where the money comes from each year

Item	Per year
Rents from space leased as it is	$478k
Land rent from the gas station	$85k
Land rent from a restaurant pad on Summer Ave	$19k
Tenants repay their share of tax, insurance and upkeep	$254k
Money coming in each year	**$837k**

Where it goes each year

Item	Per year
Allowance for empty-space gaps and unpaid rent	$19k
Property tax	$96k
Insurance, including flood	$91k
Upkeep: parking lot, lighting, landscaping, common areas	$185k
Property management	$40k
Set-aside for roof and AC repairs	$30k
Money going out each year	**$461k**

Profit each year: $375k.

What the money pays for

Buying and building, line by line, average case

Item	One-time
Buying the property (assumed $3.0M) and closing	
Purchase price (assumed)	$3.0M
Fees, closing costs, surveys and inspections	$276k
Subtotal	**$3.3M**
Building work (roof, heating and AC, fire safety, restrooms, parking, flood, columns)	
Roof repairs, coating or replacement	$481k
Heating and air conditioning (rooftop units)	$320k
Fire sprinklers	$78k
Fire alarm with voice evacuation	$119k
Clearing out the old store interior	$82k
New entrances and canopies	$104k
Walls between tenant spaces	$227k
Restrooms	$130k
Electrical	$163k
Plumbing	$52k
Parking lot repair and repaving	$275k
Site work, lighting and landscaping	$130k
Outside walls and paint	$126k
Flood compliance work	$328k
Subtotal	**$2.6M**
Finishing the halls and kitchens	
Nothing under this heading in this plan	*$0*
Subtotal	**$0**
Design, permits and a cushion for surprises	
Design, engineering, permits and surveys	$191k
Cushion for surprises	$261k
Subtotal	**$452k**
Signing tenants: build-out allowances and broker fees	
Fit-out help for tenants	$449k
Leasing commissions	$190k
Subtotal	**$639k**
Holding the building and loan interest during the work	
Tax, insurance and upkeep while building	$88k
Construction-loan interest	$73k
Subtotal	**$161k**
Money in (buying + building, one-time)	**$7.1M**

No columns to take out: this plan does not build the halls.

03 · WAYS TO IMPROVE

What would make it more profitable

Ways to spend less on the build or bring in more each year. Each change is shown on its own, against the average case.

PATH TO PROFIT

If these changes happen together

+ One more event a week across the halls
+ $1,000 more per hall booking
+ $60,000 less year-round hall staff
+ Reseal the parking lot instead of repaving
+ Caterers bring and own the kitchen equipment
+ Keep the hall columns instead of removing them OPTIONAL

Plan	Earns back now	Money put in with the changes	Profit each year with the changes	Earns back with the changes	If the columns are kept (optional)
Full plan	19.1 years	$18.8M	$1.5M	12.2 years	11.6 years
Efficient full plan	16.3 years	$15.5M	$1.5M	10.0 years	9.4 years
Hybrid	18.0 years	$14.3M	$1.4M	10.3 years	10.0 years

With these changes Efficient full plan meets the 10-year goal, with the columns taken out. Keeping the columns is optional: the owners want open halls, and the plan assumes they come out.

Every change, one plan at a time

Each line shows one change on its own, against the average case, and how many years the money put in would then take to come back.

Lease everything Now: $15.9M to build, $623k profit a year, earns it back in 25.6 years

More money coming in

Change	Profit each year	Money in (one-time)	Earns back in	Note
Shops 95% leased instead of 85%	+$60k a year	Adds $130k	23.5 years	Needs strong anchors or a busy hall complex
Kids' center pays $6.00/SF instead of $4.50	+$18k a year	Adds $20k	24.9 years	Depends on the playground operator's sales
Add a restaurant pad on Summer Ave (it rents the land, about $70,000 a year)	+$45k a year	Adds $49k	23.9 years	Needs a restaurant tenant and the 5800/5810 Summer pads

Ways to save

Change	Profit each year	Money in (one-time)	Earns back in	Note

Change	Profit each year	Money in (one-time)	Earns back in	Note
Keep the hall columns and decorate around them	No change	Saves $895k	24.1 years	Saves the steel beams; each main room keeps 2 columns. Optional: the owners want open halls, so this is a fallback only.
Roof needs only repairs and a coating	No change	Saves $648k	24.5 years	Only if a roofer confirms the roof is sound
Patch and reseal the parking lot instead of repaving	No change	Saves $302k	25.1 years	Keep repaving for the worst areas
Insurance shopped 15% cheaper	No change	No change	25.5 years	Needs quotes from two or three brokers

Full plan (as drawn) Now: $19.3M to build, $1.0M profit a year, earns it back in 19.1 years

More money coming in

Change	Profit each year	Money in (one-time)	Earns back in	Note
One more event a week across the halls (+52 a year)	+$254k a year	Adds $142k	15.4 years	Weddings, engagements, corporate and community events
Charge $1,000 more per hall booking	+$166k a year	Adds $93k	16.5 years	Comparable Memphis halls ask $7,000–9,000 on a Saturday; premium venues $10,000–12,000
Cater 10% more of the events in-house	+$46k a year	Adds $26k	18.3 years	In-house catering earns more than an outside-caterer kitchen fee
Charge $5 more per guest for catering	+$48k a year	Adds $27k	18.2 years	Memphis buffets run $18–35 per guest and plated meals $28–52
Shops 95% leased instead of 85%	+$54k a year	Adds $126k	18.2 years	Needs strong anchors or a busy hall complex
Kids' center pays $6.00/SF instead of $4.50	+$17k a year	Adds $19k	18.8 years	Depends on the playground operator's sales
Add a restaurant pad on Summer Ave (it rents the land, about $70,000 a year)	+$41k a year	Adds $47k	18.4 years	Needs a restaurant tenant and the 5800/5810 Summer pads

Ways to save

Change	Profit each year	Money in (one-time)	Earns back in	Note
Run the halls with $60,000 less year-round staff	+$53k a year	Adds $30k	18.2 years	Owner-managed, with part-time event staff
Keep the hall columns and decorate around them	No change	Saves $895k	18.2 years	Saves the steel beams; each main room keeps 2 columns. Optional: the owners want open halls, so this is a fallback only.
Roof needs only repairs and a coating	No change	Saves $648k	18.4 years	Only if a roofer confirms the roof is sound
Patch and reseal the parking lot instead of repaving	No change	Saves $302k	18.8 years	Keep repaving for the worst areas
Basic hall finishes ($20/SF less)	−$12k a year	Saves $638k	18.7 years	Simpler ceilings and lighting; décor rented per event
Caterers bring and own the kitchen equipment	−$7k a year	Saves $397k	18.8 years	Kitchen shell, hoods and grease trap stay with the owner

Change	Profit each year	Money in (one-time)	Earns back in	Note
Insurance shopped 15% cheaper	No change	No change	19.0 years	Needs quotes from two or three brokers

Full plan, built efficiently Now: $16.0M to build, $981k profit a year, earns it back in 16.3 years

More money coming in

Change	Profit each year	Money in (one-time)	Earns back in	Note
One more event a week across the halls (+52 a year)	+$270k a year	Adds $126k	12.9 years	Weddings, engagements, corporate and community events
Charge $1,000 more per hall booking	+$172k a year	Adds $80k	14.0 years	Comparable Memphis halls ask $7,000–9,000 on a Saturday; premium venues $10,000–12,000
Cater 10% more of the events in-house	+$52k a year	Adds $24k	15.5 years	In-house catering earns more than an outside-caterer kitchen fee
Charge $5 more per guest for catering	+$53k a year	Adds $25k	15.5 years	Memphis buffets run $18–35 per guest and plated meals $28–52
Shops 95% leased instead of 85%	+$51k a year	Adds $99k	15.6 years	Needs strong anchors or a busy hall complex
Kids' center pays $6.00/SF instead of $4.50	+$17k a year	Adds $17k	16.1 years	Depends on the playground operator's sales
Add a restaurant pad on Summer Ave (it rents the land, about $70,000 a year)	+$41k a year	Adds $43k	15.7 years	Needs a restaurant tenant and the 5800/5810 Summer pads

Ways to save

Change	Profit each year	Money in (one-time)	Earns back in	Note
Run the halls with $60,000 less year-round staff	+$53k a year	Adds $25k	15.5 years	Owner-managed, with part-time event staff
Keep the hall columns and decorate around them	No change	Saves $880k	15.4 years	Saves the steel beams; each main room keeps 2 columns. Optional: the owners want open halls, so this is a fallback only.
Roof needs only repairs and a coating	No change	Saves $376k	15.9 years	Only if a roofer confirms the roof is sound
Patch and reseal the parking lot instead of repaving	No change	Saves $277k	16.0 years	Keep repaving for the worst areas
Basic hall finishes ($20/SF less)	−$12k a year	Saves $647k	15.9 years	Simpler ceilings and lighting; décor rented per event
Caterers bring and own the kitchen equipment	−$6k a year	Saves $356k	16.1 years	Kitchen shell, hoods and grease trap stay with the owner
Insurance shopped 15% cheaper	+$5k a year	No change	16.3 years	Needs quotes from two or three brokers

Hybrid (phased) Now: $14.7M to build, $819k profit a year, earns it back in 18.0 years

More money coming in

Change	Profit each year	Money in (one-time)	Earns back in	Note

Change	Profit each year	Money in (one-time)	Earns back in	Note
One more event a week across the halls (+52 a year)	+$269k a year	No change	13.5 years	Weddings, engagements, corporate and community events
Charge $1,000 more per hall booking	+$171k a year	No change	14.9 years	Comparable Memphis halls ask $7,000–9,000 on a Saturday; premium venues $10,000–12,000
Cater 10% more of the events in-house	+$52k a year	No change	16.9 years	In-house catering earns more than an outside-caterer kitchen fee
Charge $5 more per guest for catering	+$53k a year	No change	16.9 years	Memphis buffets run $18–35 per guest and plated meals $28–52
Kids' center pays $6.00/SF instead of $4.50	+$17k a year	Adds $15k	17.6 years	Depends on the playground operator's sales
Space leased as it is: 85% leased instead of the average case	+$49k a year	Adds $74k	17.0 years	Large blocks lease slowly; this is the upside
Add a restaurant pad on Summer Ave (it rents the land, about $70,000 a year)	+$41k a year	Adds $36k	17.2 years	Needs a restaurant tenant and the 5800/5810 Summer pads

Ways to save

Change	Profit each year	Money in (one-time)	Earns back in	Note
Run the halls with $60,000 less year-round staff	+$53k a year	No change	16.9 years	Owner-managed, with part-time event staff
Keep the hall columns and decorate around them	No change	Saves $440k	17.4 years	Saves the steel beams; each main room keeps 2 columns. Optional: the owners want open halls, so this is a fallback only.
Roof needs only repairs and a coating	No change	Saves $376k	17.5 years	Only if a roofer confirms the roof is sound
Patch and reseal the parking lot instead of repaving	No change	Saves $277k	17.6 years	Keep repaving for the worst areas
Basic hall finishes ($20/SF less)	−$7k a year	Saves $422k	17.6 years	Simpler ceilings and lighting; décor rented per event
Caterers bring and own the kitchen equipment	No change	Saves $190k	17.8 years	Kitchen shell, hoods and grease trap stay with the owner
Insurance shopped 15% cheaper	+$5k a year	No change	17.9 years	Needs quotes from two or three brokers

Lean hold Now: $7.1M to build, $375k profit a year, earns it back in 19.0 years

More money coming in

Change	Profit each year	Money in (one-time)	Earns back in	Note
Space leased as it is: 85% leased instead of the average case	+$160k a year	Adds $171k	13.7 years	Large blocks lease slowly; this is the upside
Add a restaurant pad on Summer Ave (it rents the land, about $70,000 a year)	+$43k a year	Adds $31k	17.2 years	Needs a restaurant tenant and the 5800/5810 Summer pads

Ways to save

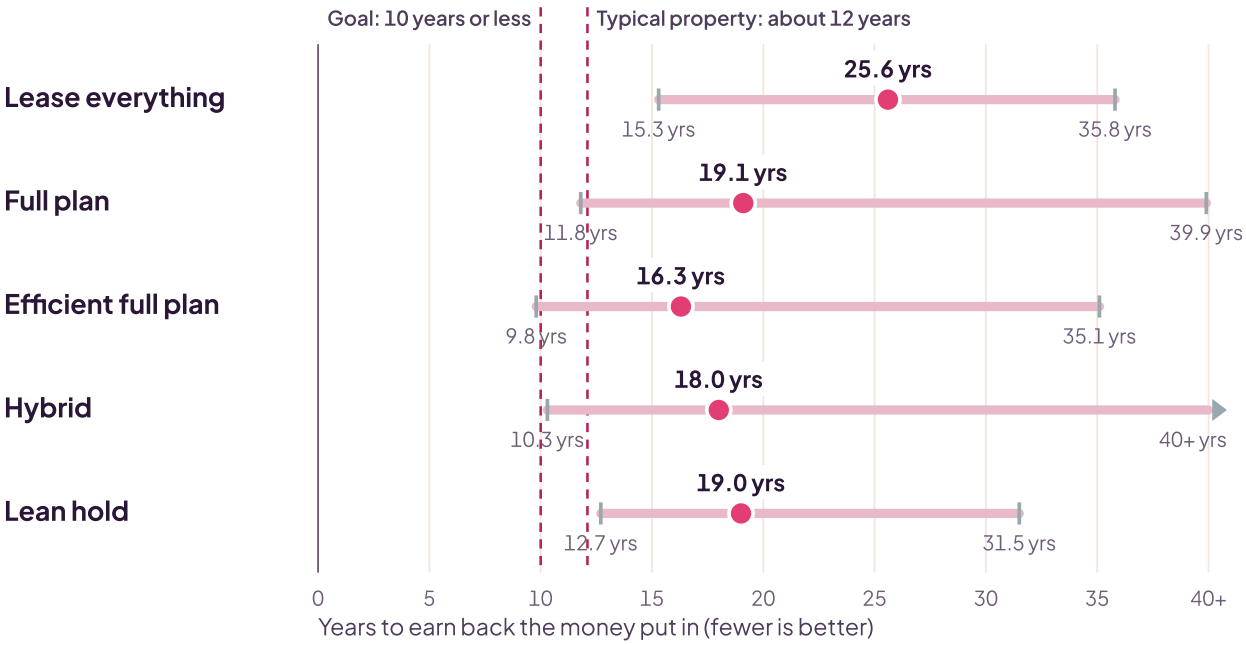
Change	Profit each year	Money in (one-time)	Earns back in	Note
Roof needs only repairs and a coating	No change	Saves $296k	18.2 years	Only if a roofer confirms the roof is sound
Patch and reseal the parking lot instead of repaving	No change	Saves $129k	18.7 years	Keep repaving for the worst areas
Insurance shopped 15% cheaper	No change	No change	18.9 years	Needs quotes from two or three brokers

04 · THE RANGE

How long each plan takes to earn back the money put in

All three cases at once. Fewer years is better.

In the average case no plan earns back the money put in faster than a typical investment property (about 12 years); three of five do in the best case, none in the worst



Years to earn back the one-time money put in, including buying the property at an assumed $3.0M plus fees and closing. Fewer years is better. Each grey bar runs from the best case (left) to the worst case (right); the blue dot is the average case. “Never” means the plan loses money in that case, and the chart stops at 40 years. Dashed lines: the 10-year goal and a typical investment property (about 12 years).

The numbers as a table

All three cases for every plan

Plan	Case	Money in (buying + building)	Profit each year	Years to earn back	Profit per $100 spent
Lease everything	Worst	$18.2M	$508k	35.8 years	$2.80
Lease everything	**Average**	$15.9M	$623k	25.6 years	$3.91
Lease everything	Best	$14.2M	$928k	15.3 years	$6.55
Full plan	Worst	$22.1M	$554k	39.9 years	$2.51

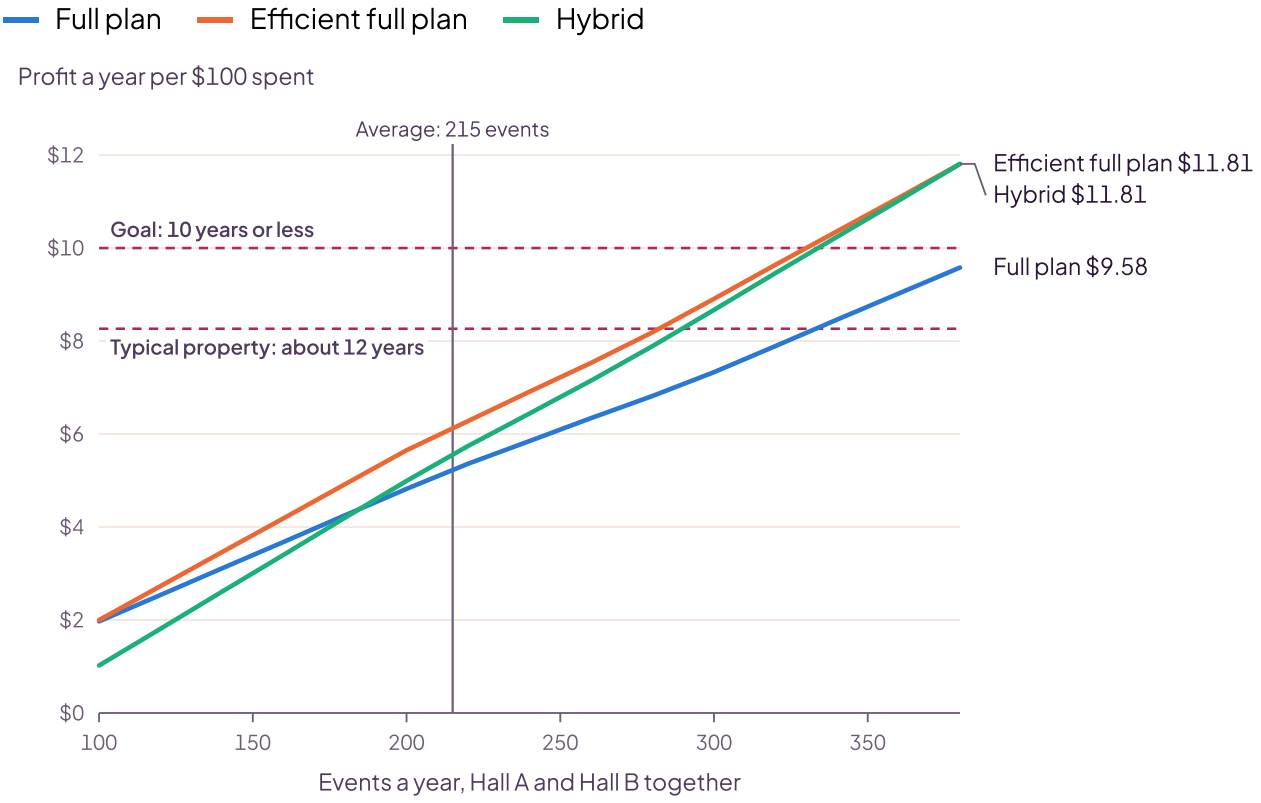
Plan	Case	Money in (buying + building)	Profit each year	Years to earn back	Profit per $100 spent
Full plan	**Average**	**$19.3M**	**$1.0M**	**19.1 years**	**$5.24**
Full plan	Best	$17.2M	$1.5M	11.8 years	$8.48
Efficient full plan	Worst	$18.1M	$517k	35.1 years	$2.85
Efficient full plan	**Average**	**$16.0M**	**$981k**	**16.3 years**	**$6.12**
Efficient full plan	Best	$14.2M	$1.5M	9.8 years	$10.22
Hybrid	Worst	$16.7M	$344k	More than 40 years	$2.05
Hybrid	**Average**	**$14.7M**	**$819k**	**18.0 years**	**$5.56**
Hybrid	Best	$13.0M	$1.3M	10.3 years	$9.73
Lean hold	Worst	$7.9M	$249k	31.5 years	$3.17
Lean hold	**Average**	**$7.1M**	**$375k**	**19.0 years**	**$5.26**
Lean hold	Best	$6.5M	$514k	12.7 years	$7.86

05 · WHAT HAS TO BE TRUE

How many events a year the halls need

Everything else stays at the average case. Only the number of events a year across Hall A and Hall B changes.

Efficient full plan meets the 10-year goal at about 330 events a year; the average case has 215



Profit each year for every $100 put in, including buying the property at an assumed $3.0M plus fees and closing, for the three plans where the owners run the halls. Everything except bookings stays at the average case. Dashed lines: the 10-year goal ($10.00 a year per $100) and a typical investment property (about 12 years) ($8.26 per $100). The solid line marks the average case, 215 events.

The average case assumes 215 events a year across Hall A and Hall B.

Full plan: about 333 events a year to beat a typical investment property (about 12 years), and does not meet the 10-year goal in this range.

Efficient full plan: about 282 events a year to beat a typical investment property (about 12 years), and about 330 to meet the 10-year goal.

Hybrid: about 289 events a year to beat a typical investment property (about 12 years), and about 334 to meet the 10-year goal.

The numbers as a table

Each plan at each level of bookings

Events a year	Full plan	Efficient full plan	Hybrid
100	$1.97 (40+ yrs)	$2.00 (40+ yrs)	$1.02 (40+ yrs)
120	$2.54 (39.4 yrs)	$2.73 (36.6 yrs)	$1.81 (40+ yrs)
140	$3.11 (32.2 yrs)	$3.46 (28.9 yrs)	$2.61 (38.3 yrs)
160	$3.68 (27.2 yrs)	$4.19 (23.9 yrs)	$3.40 (29.4 yrs)
180	$4.25 (23.5 yrs)	$4.92 (20.3 yrs)	$4.20 (23.8 yrs)
200	$4.82 (20.7 yrs)	$5.65 (17.7 yrs)	$4.99 (20.0 yrs)
220	$5.36 (18.7 yrs)	$6.28 (15.9 yrs)	$5.74 (17.4 yrs)
240	$5.85 (17.1 yrs)	$6.91 (14.5 yrs)	$6.44 (15.5 yrs)
260	$6.34 (15.8 yrs)	$7.53 (13.3 yrs)	$7.15 (14.0 yrs)
280	$6.82 (14.7 yrs)	$8.19 (12.2 yrs)	$7.89 (12.7 yrs)
300	$7.33 (13.6 yrs)	$8.91 (11.2 yrs)	$8.67 (11.5 yrs)
320	$7.89 (12.7 yrs)	$9.64 (10.4 yrs)	$9.46 (10.6 yrs)
340	$8.46 (11.8 yrs)	$10.36 (9.7 yrs)	$10.24 (9.8 yrs)
360	$9.02 (11.1 yrs)	$11.08 (9.0 yrs)	$11.02 (9.1 yrs)
380	$9.58 (10.4 yrs)	$11.81 (8.5 yrs)	$11.81 (8.5 yrs)

06 · THE BUSINESSES

How each business does on its own

The businesses behind the rents, shown for the **average** case. A tenant's profit is what it keeps after paying rent and its share of property costs.

Event halls (Hall A and Hall B), run by the owners

IN SHORT
Covers its costs at about 108 events a year; keeps 26 cents of every sales dollar

Events a year	215
Money coming in (sales)	$2.5M a year
Profit each year	**$625k**
No rent to pay: the owners run it	
Kept from every sales dollar	26 cents

Money to finish the halls and kitchens (one-time)	$3.5M
Events needed to cover its costs	108 a year
Rent an outside hall company could afford	$2.00 per square foot a year

Kids' indoor playground (a tenant)

IN SHORT
Makes $17.20 a year for every $100 it puts in; earns it back in 5.8 years

Money coming in (sales)	**$1.1M a year**
Profit before rent	**$348k**
Rent and its share of property costs	**$148k a year**
Rent of $4.85 per square foot a year	

Profit each year after rent	**$200k**
Money the operator puts in (one-time)	**$1.2M**
Profit each year for every $100 put in	**$17.20**
Years to earn back its money	**5.8 years**

Gas station and store (a fuel company renting the land)

IN SHORT
Thin at these fuel sales: $4.40 a year for every $100 it puts in

Fuel sold	**99,100 gallons a month**
Land rent it pays the property	**$85k a year**
Store profit each year after land rent	**$172k**

Money the fuel company puts in (one-time)	**$3.9M**
Profit each year for every $100 put in	**$4.40**
Years to earn back its money	**22.5 years**

A shop tenant

IN SHORT
Needs about $157 of sales per square foot a year so rent and shared costs stay at 10 cents of each sales dollar

Rent	**$12.55 per square foot a year**
Its share of property costs	**$3.18 per square foot a year**

Sales it needs	**$157 per square foot a year**
For a 1,500 square foot shop	**$236k of sales a year**

07 · ROOF COLUMNS IN THE HALLS

Both main rooms are planned with no columns

Four existing roof columns stand inside the two main rooms, two in each.

The 1997 drawings show existing roof columns on a ~44.5 ft grid, two inside each 11,000 SF main room. Every plan with halls takes them out and adds long steel beams (transfer girders) to hold the roof, so both rooms are open. A structural engineer must confirm the framing, footings and clear height before any binding commitment.

Taking them out is expected to cost $187k per column in the average case, $748k for all four. That is already counted in the money put in for Lease everything, Full plan, Efficient full plan and Hybrid. Hybrid takes out Hall A's columns first and Hall B's when Hall B is added.

08 · BETTER OR WORSE

Why the average case could be wrong

The average case is the typical outcome of 10,000 simulated futures built from public information, not from contractor bids, surveys or signed tenants.

Why it could turn out better

The floor is confirmed above 250 ft. USGS lidar puts the ground 2–4 ft above the 248 ft flood level along about 85% of the walls. If an elevation certificate confirms the floor, flood work drops to the survey and fixes at the rear dock area.

Bids come in under desk estimates. Roof, HVAC and parking are the biggest swings. County permits show $249,911 of repairs in 2020 and a $423,850 alteration in 2012, so some systems may be newer than assumed. Coating a sound roof instead of replacing it saves about $0.3–0.6M.

Prices reach the premium tier. Once the halls have reviews, premium Memphis venues ask $10,000–12,000 for a 300–400 guest Saturday (the Cadre Building $12,200; Memphis Botanic Garden $10,000), and a full room for 650–700 guests rents for $11,000–15,000. The average case assumes about $5,550 per event across all days.

Hall demand beats 215 events a year. Daytime and evening events on weekends, weekday corporate and church business, and lower off-peak prices can push bookings toward 260–300 a year once each room can be split. About 1,100–1,200 girls in the metro's Hispanic community turn 15 each year, and the largest listed banquet halls in Jackson, MS hold about 350 guests.

Few large halls nearby. No hall outside the hotels seating 500 or more was found in northeast Memphis, Raleigh or Bartlett. The nearest are in Cordova and Germantown (FedEx Event Center, about 500 seated; Esplanade, 400) and downtown (The Kent, 600), and the 900-seat ballroom at the former Memphis Vitality Hotel has closed.

The outparcels earn more. A credit fuel tenant on the frontage and a quick-service pad on Summer Avenue add about $146k a year in the best case, and up to $230k a year if both lease at the top of the market.

Cheaper financing applies. SBA 504 loans need the owners' business to occupy at least 51% of an existing building. The halls alone are about 37%; running the kids' center as well brings it to about 52%.

Why it could turn out worse

Shops lease slowly. The retail sits deep in the site behind other buildings, and Summer Avenue is under construction until mid-2028.

Large as-is blocks sit empty. The building is empty, large blocks lease slowly, and Memphis big-box vacancy rose in 2026 as furniture stores left and IKEA announced it is closing its 270,000 SF Cordova store.

Bookings start slow. Couples book their venue 12–18 months ahead, so a new hall needs about three years to fill: roughly 110–140 events in year 1 and 170–200 in year 2. Mid-market Memphis halls fill Saturdays only 3–9 months ahead and discount late dates (The Palace at Cordova sells dates inside 30 days from $3,500), and hotel ballrooms, the Esplanade and The Columns compete for large events.

Most weddings are smaller than these rooms. The average wedding has about 117 guests, and most Memphis halls hold 100–350. Two rooms have only 104 Saturdays a year between them, so most of the 215 events must be smaller events on other days. Without the movable walls that split each room, bookings could stay near 120–160 a year.

The building hides costs. A 1984 building converting to assembly use can need more fire alarm (voice evacuation above 1,000 occupants), exit, restroom and electrical work than estimated. The budget's cushion for surprises covers some of this, not all.

Removing the columns costs more than assumed. The steel beams that replace the columns need sound footings at their ends and enough height below the roof. The budget is about $187,000 per column (about $0.7M for four), with the steel fabricator and structural engineer hired directly; contractor-delivered jobs elsewhere ran $207,000–480,000 per column.

One contractor does the whole job. The costs assume the ownership group manages the work and hires each trade directly. A general contractor typically adds about 11–22% for its overhead and profit: about $1.8M more for the efficient full plan, which would then take about 18.0 years instead of 16.3 to earn back, buying the property included.

The earthquake code applies. Memphis is near the New Madrid fault. If the large rooms together hold more than 2,500 people, the code can require strengthening the whole building, which could cost more than the columns.

The flood answer goes the wrong way. If the survey finds the floor below 250 ft, flood work rises toward the top of its range, about $0.85M instead of about $0.3M in the average case, and flood insurance costs more. The ground levels around the building make this unlikely.

The fuel pad stays empty. At average volumes a fuel company keeps only about $4 a year for every $100 it spends on a roughly $3.9M station, so a ground lease is not assured. The frontage parcel is also marketed on its own.

09 · NOT KNOWN YET

What is not known yet

Each of these is settled before any binding commitment.

Floor elevation

Elevation certificate and boundary survey: finished floor against the 250 ft requirement, and the ground at the rear docks.

Structure

Structural engineer: roof framing, column and footing capacity, clear height, and a price for removing four columns.

Building systems

Roof, rooftop units, electrical service, sprinkler riser and fire alarm: age and condition.

Zoning

City letter confirming event halls, indoor recreation and fuel in CMU-3, and the zoning of the frontage parcel.

Environment

Phase I environmental assessment covering the former quick-lube on the frontage.

Demand

Commitments or letters of intent from caterers, a hall operator, a playground operator and shop tenants.

Earthquake code

If the building's large rooms (over 300 people each) add up to more than 2,500 people, the 2021 building code can require earthquake strengthening of the whole building. Capping each hall's posted capacity is the likely fix; a structural engineer and the City must confirm.

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WORDS USED ON THIS PAGE

What the words mean

Worst, average and best case

Likely outcomes, not extremes. Every input (costs, rents, bookings, prices) has a researched range, and thousands of simulated futures let each land anywhere in it. Worst: only 1 in 10 futures do worse. Average: the typical future. Best: only 1 in 10 do better.

Money in (buying + building, one-time)

Buying the property at an assumed $3.0M plus fees, closing costs, surveys and inspections, then repairs, building work, finishing the inside, design and permits, a cushion for surprises, the cost of signing tenants, and holding the building while work goes on.

Money coming in each year

Rent from tenants plus sales from the halls where the owners run them, once the building is open.

Money going out each year

The yearly running costs: property tax, insurance, upkeep, management, a repairs reserve, empty space and unpaid rent, and the halls' staff, food and other costs.

Profit each year

Money coming in minus money going out, before any loan payments.

Years to earn back the money put in

The one-time money in (buying and building) divided by the profit each year. Fewer years is better.

Profit each year for every $100 spent

The same idea the other way round: $10 a year for every $100 spent earns the money back in 10 years.

Typical investment property

A finished, rented property like this one usually sells for about 12 years of its profit. A plan that earns back faster creates value; one that takes longer is worth less than it cost to build.

The 10-year goal

This study's goal: earn back the money put in within 10 years, which is $10 a year for every $100 spent.

Your test numbers

Numbers you type in "Try your own numbers". They stay on your screen for this visit only, are not saved and are not part of the study.

Owner-run

Run by the owners' own operating company instead of being rented to another business.

Tenant's share of property costs

On top of rent, tenants pay their share of property tax, insurance and upkeep of shared areas.

Land lease

A business rents only the land, builds its own building on it and pays rent for the land.

Transfer girder

A deep steel beam that holds up the roof where a column used to stand, so the column can come out.

SF

Square feet.

SYCAMORE SQUARE

Planning estimates from public data and market research, 18 Oct 2026. Not an offer, appraisal or financial advice; numbers change with survey, flood, zoning and bids.

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